

Unit 07: Blood Relation

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Objective

The key concepts explained in this unit, including area a learner is expected to learn and master after going through the unit are: -

- We will understand how find Family or Blood Relationship.
- We will understand how find Relationships Involving the Term ‘-in-law’ General
- We will understand how find Relationships Involving Father-in-law, Mother-in-law, Son-in-law and Daughter-in-law
- We will understand how find Relationships Involving Brother-in-law and Sister-in-law
- We will understand how find Relationships Half Sibling and Step Relations.

Introduction

Blood Relations is the most studied topic of Logical Reasoning and is one of the few topics which has found its importance in almost every entrance exam. This topic tests the analytical skills of the students and how one can approach the solution of logical problems with the help of diagrams instead of calculations. The diagrams play an important role here. The right diagrams come from the right analysis. The following is the list of exams in which the appearance of questions from blood relations are frequent. Any relation in the world which either by birth or by marriage is called a Blood Relation. Relation as we know is the connection between any two things or between any two persons. So when speaking of blood relation, it means the connection between two people by blood or basically by birth.



Example: Any relation by birth will be mother, father, son, daughter, etc. and any relation by marriage will be father-in-law, mother-in-law, etc.

7.1 Types of Questions on Blood Relation

Over the years, the standard and type of questions which are being asked from the blood relation topic have seen a slight turn. Initially, the questions used to be less complex and statement or dialogue-based, but with the increased competition, the variety of questions being asked have also changed.

Being one of the most common concepts from which questions are asked in exams, given below are the different ways in which the blood relation questions may be asked in the competitive exams, for the assistance of candidates:

Dialogue/ Conversation Based – Based on Dialogue or conversation. In such questions, one person describes his/her relation with another person (this may or may not be related to the person with whom the conversation is being made).

Based on Puzzles – To make the questions complex, blood relation questions are also being asked in the form of a puzzle. A piece of brief information about multiple people being interrelated is given and sub-questions based on the same may be asked.

Coding-Decoding – The relationship between two people may be denoted using symbols. This has become a common method of asking blood relation questions in competitive exams, nowadays.

Keep in mind that from a person's name, we cannot judge the gender of that person. The name doesn't always show the gender beyond a reasonable doubt.

A tree as we know has roots firmly grounded and then it has its stem which branches out and gets leaves in it.

Basic Terms used in Blood Relations

Parents: Mother and father.

Children: Son or Daughter

Siblings: Brother or Sister(of the same parents)

Spouse: Husband or wife.

Aunt: Aunt means father's sister, mother's sister, father's brother's wife, or mother's brother's wife.

Uncle: Uncle means father's brother, Mother's brother, Father's sister's husband, mother's sister's husband.

Niece: Brother's and sister's daughter.

Nephew: Brother's and sister's son.

Cousin: Children of aunt and uncle.

Father-in-law: Father of the spouse.

Mother-in-law: Mother of Spouse.

Sister-in-law: Sister of the spouse, wife of brother

Co-sister: Wife of spouse's brother.

Brother-in-law: Brother of the spouse, husband of the sister

Co- brother: husband of spouse's sister.

Maternal: Relations or family members who are from the mother's side.

Paternal: Relations or family members who are from the father's side.



Note:

I. Any relation of Mother's side is called 'Maternal'.

II. Any relation of Father's side is called 'Paternal'.



For example: Pointing towards a boy Veena said "He is the son of only son of my grandfather". How is that boy related to Veena?

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Solution: He is the son of only son of my grandfather – Veen's Father's son

Therefore, that boy is a Veena's brother.

The same is the case with a family tree, wherein we can imagine our ancestors as the roots and then their children and grandchildren and so on act as branches and leaves.

Family Tree a pictorial or visual representation of our lineage. With the help of a family tree, it not only gives us a better understanding of our lineage but also helps us understand our relationship with different people who have common ancestors.

There also are a few things which need to be kept in mind while solving the blood relation questions. Given below are few such important pointers:

You cannot assume the gender of the person based on the name

If the statement says X is the son of Y, the gender of Y cannot be determined unless mentioned in the question

In puzzle based questions, a web of relations can be formed, so do not solve such questions in a haste

These questions are scoring and easy to solve, so do not panic if the question seems lengthy

In case of coding-decoding blood relation, use a pictorial description to solve the question. This will make the symbols and relation more clear

To ace the reasoning section, candidates can visit the 3 Sutras to Prepare Reasoning Ability at the linked article.

Let us now move on to solving a few sample questions to get a better understanding of the concept.

7.2 Family Or Blood Relations Test

Tips on finding a relationship between two members of a family:

Step 1: The first and foremost step is to choose the two persons among whom the relationship is to be established.

Step 2: Now once you have chosen the two persons, pin-point the intermediate relationship between two persons, i.e. such relationship through which long drawn relationship can be established between the required persons.

Step 3: In the end, conclude the relationship between two required persons.

Make sure that you represent the gender of a female with a "□" sign and that of a male with a "⊕"

Definition and Concept

Family or Blood Relationship means persons connected by relations like – father-mother, son-daughter, brother-sister, grandfather-grandmother, uncle-aunty, nephew-niece, brother-in-law-sister-in-law etc. The list can go on and on adding members from father's side and mother's side etc.

Questions in Test of Reasoning on Family /Blood Relationship are about the relationship of a particular person with another person of the family, based on the chain of relationships between other members of that family.

The questions depict relationships among the various members of a family in a roundabout chain. The candidate is expected to find the relation of two particular persons mentioned in the question. An example of a question on Blood Relationship is given below to understand the concept in a better way:



Example 1: Introducing Neeta, Anil said, 'She is wife of my mother's only son.' How is Neeta related to Anil?

Analytical Skills-I

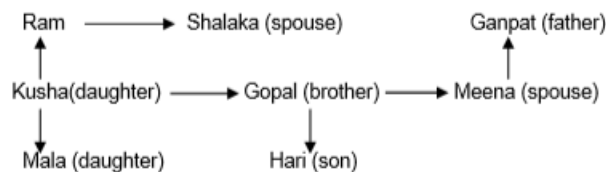
- (1) Mother
- (2) Wife
- (3) Sister
- (4) Daughter-in-law
- (5) None of these

Solution: Neeta is the wife of Anil's mother's only son, who is Anil himself. Hence, answer is Neeta is Anil's wife. i.e. (2) Wife.

Example 2: 'Ram' is the father of 'Kusha' but 'Kusha' is not his son. 'Mala' is the daughter of 'Kusha'. 'Shalaka' is the spouse of 'Ram'. 'Gopal' is the brother of 'Kusha'. 'Hari' is the son of 'Gopal'. 'Meena' is the spouse of 'Gopal'. 'Ganpat' is the father of 'Meena'. Who is the grand daughter of 'Ram'?

- (1) Hari
- (2) Mala
- (3) Meena
- (4) Shalaka
- (5) None of these

Solution:



'Mala' is the daughter of 'Kusha' and 'Ram' is the father of 'Kusha'. So, 'Mala' is the granddaughter of 'Ram'. Hence, answer is (2) Mala.

Family/Blood Relation Tests are an exercise to test the candidate's ability to comprehend and come to the crux of an issue from complex, lengthy and unclear data.

On a lighter note, this topic of Family/Blood Relations should be of interest to the candidates who are fans of Hindi Cinema, as the nature of the questions on Family/Blood Relations are of the type 'Hum Aapke Hai Kaun

7.3 Family/Blood Relations Described General

Family/Blood Relations tests largely depend on the candidate's knowledge of family relations. Various family relationships are described below to help the candidates to understand the relationships better and to attempt the questions based on them with confidence.

Some Common Terms

Meaning of some terms often used in questions on family relationship are given below:

- a) Parent – Mother or father
- b) Child – Son or daughter (even if an adult)
- c) Sibling – Brother or sister (Including half brother and half sister - one parent in common)
- d) Spouse – Husband or wife

Basic Relationships Aunt, Uncle, Niece and Nephew

Most English speakers use "uncle" for any of four relationships: father's brother, mother's brother, father's sister's husband, or mother's sister's husband.

Again, "aunt" in English could mean father's sister, mother's sister, father's brother's wife, or mother's brother's wife.

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Brother's or sister's son is called nephew. Brother's or sister's daughter is called niece.

Children of aunt or uncle are called cousins.

7.4 Relationships Involving the Term '-in-law' General

Any relationship term ending with -in-law indicates that the relationship is by marriage and not by blood. In other words, -in-law will be a blood relative of the spouse. ¹³ In-law relationship terms are always written with hyphens. And the plural is formed on the part before the "-in-law"; for example, "brothers-in-law" and not "brother-in-laws". The only exception is the general term "in-laws", which is always plural.

7.5 Father-in-law, Mother-in-law, Son-in-law and Daughter-in-law

Father-in-law is the father of spouse; mother-in-law is the mother of spouse. If parents get divorced and remarry, their new spouses are called stepparents, not mother-in-law and father-in-law.

The husband of daughter is son-in-law; the wife of son is daughter-in-law. If spouse has children from a previous marriage, those are called stepchildren, not sons-in-law or daughters-in-law. The person is their stepfather or stepmother, not their father-in-law or mother-in-law.

7.6 Brother-in-law and Sister-in-law

Brother-in-law" and "Sister-in-law" each have two or three meanings as follows:

- a) Sister-in-law could be
 - i) The sister of spouse, or
 - ii) The wife of brother, or
 - iii) The wife of spouse's brother.
- b) Similarly, Brother-in-law could be
 - i) The brother of spouse, or
 - ii) The husband of sister, or
 - iii) The husband of spouse's sister

Relationships Involving the Terms 'Grand' and 'Great'

The relationships of the second generation are prefixed with the word Grand. For example, for a person, the first generation below him/her would be that of his/her child/children. The next/second generation would be the children of the children who would be called Grand Children of that person. The next/ third generation children would be called Great Grand Children of that person. This also applies to Niece and Nephew. For example, Son of nephew of a person is called Grand Nephew and so on

Similarly, for a person, the first generation above him would be that of his/her parents (Father/ Mother). The next/second generation above him/her would be the parents of the parents who would be called Grand Parents/ Grand Father/ Grand Mother of that person. The next/ third generation parents would be called Great Grand Parents/ Great Grand Father/ Great Grand Mother of that person.

This also applies to the collateral relationships. For example, Son of nephew of a person is called Grand Nephew; Brother of Grand Father is called Grand Uncle and so on.

The fourth-generation relationships are called Great Great Grand. For example, Son of Great Grand Son is Great Great Grand Son.

*Analytical Skills-I***7.7 Half Sibling and Step Relations**

Questions on Half Sibling and Step Relations are not very common in Bank exams. The information given below is only for very discerning candidates.

A half sibling (half brother or half sister) is a sibling with one shared biological parent.

When a parent remarries, the new spouse is the stepfather or stepmother of any children from the previous marriage. The children from a previous marriage are stepsons and stepdaughters. One is called stepbrother or stepsister if they have no parents in common but their parents have married each other. There are two ways Martha could have a stepsister:

a) If Martha's mother marries second time, and her new husband (Martha's new stepfather) already has a daughter from a previous marriage, that daughter is Martha's stepsister because one of her parents is married to one of Martha's parents.

b) If Martha's father marries second time, and his new wife already has a daughter, that daughter is again Martha's stepsister.

A similar rule gives the two ways for stepbrother.

Summary of Some Common Relationships

Summary of some common Relationships is given below in tabular forms:

Relation	Commonly Used Terms
Grandfather's or Grandmother's only son	Father
Grandfather's or Grandmother's only daughter-in-law	Mother
Father's father or Mother's	Grandfather
Father's Mother or Mother's	Grandmother
Father's brother or Mother's	Uncle
Father's sister or Mother's	Aunt
Son's wife	Daughter-in-law
Daughter's husband	Son-in-law
Husband's or wife's sister	Sister-in-law
Husband's or wife's brother	Brother-in-law
Brother's wife	Sister-in-law
Brother's or sister's son	Nephew
Brother's or sister's daughter	Niece
Uncle's or aunt's son or daughter	Cousin
Sister's husband	Brother-in-law
Brother's wife	Sister-in-law
Grand son's or grand daughter's daughter	Grand Grand Daughter

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Grand son's or grand daughter's son	Great Grand Son
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	0	1	2	3	4
0	Common Ancestor (Husband-Wife)	Child (son or daughter)	Grandchild	Great Grandchild	2 Great Grandchild
1	Child (son or daughter)	Sibling (brother or sister)	Nephew or Niece	Grand Nephew or Niece	Great Grand Nephew or Niece
2	Grandchild	Nephew or Niece	First Cousin		
3	Great Grandchild	Grand Nephew or Niece		Second Cousin	
4	2 Great Grandchild	Great Grand Nephew or Niece			Third Cousin

Types of Questions on Blood Relations

Questions on Blood Relations are of the following types:

- Mixed-Up Relationship Descriptions.
- Relationships Riddle.
- Coded Relations

Type I - Mixed-Up Relationship Descriptions

Concept and Example

In questions of Mixed-Up Relationship Descriptions, a cluttered and roundabout description of relationships is given. The candidate is required to decipher the whole chain of relations and identify the direct/ actual relationship between the concerned persons.

A solved example of the Mixed-Up Relationship Descriptions is given below to understand the concept and questions based on it.



Example: Pointing to a gentleman, Dinesh said "His only brother is the father of my daughter's father." How is the gentleman related to Dinesh?

- Uncle
- Grandfather
- Father
- Brother- in-law
- None of these

Analytical Skills-I

Solution: The gentleman's only brother is the father of Dinesh (Dinesh daughter's father is Dinesh himself.). Gentleman is brother of Dinesh's father. Gentleman is Dinesh's uncle. Hence, answer is (1) Uncle.

Basic Skills and Tips for Solving Questions on Mixed-Up Relationship Descriptions

To make the chain of relationships clear, where necessary a rough sketch of family tree may be prepared in pencil on question paper on the basis of descriptions given in the question. The person's of same generation may be placed on same horizontal level and that of different generation one below the other. It may sometimes be necessary to draw two different diagrams and then put them together based on the link provided.

The relationship may be shown by drawing lines / arrows. Short forms as follows may be used to indicate the nature of relationships:

g - Gentleman/ Male	s - Sister	u - Uncle	snl - Son-in-law
l - Lady/ Female	b - Brother	a - Aunt	dl - Daughter-in-law
sp -Spouse	sn - Son	cb - Cousin Brother	pu - Paternal Uncle
ch - Child	d - Daughter	cs - Cousin Sister	mu - Maternal Uncle
h - Husband	gf - Grandfather	nf - Nephew	
w - Wife	gm - Grandmother	nc - Niece	
m - Mother	gs - Grandson	bl - Brother-in-law	
f - Father	gd - Granddaughter	sl - Sister-in-law	

Use of Small letters is suggested to indicate the nature of relationships to avoid confusion of Capital alphabets used in the questions like 'A is mother of C', 'D is sister of B's husband'

Sometimes even re-writing the given information using the short forms helps in reducing the confusion. The candidates may also, where possible try to correlate the given relationships with their own kith and kin. This works wonderfully in understanding the relationship.

It is observed that the names given in the questions are sometimes deceptive as to the gender. Candidates are advised to follow the instructions given in the question ignoring the name of the gender as at times it is deceptive. e.g. Kamal, Milan, Preetam, Kiran, Jasbir, Jasprit and etc.

Quite often descriptions of superfluous (unnecessary/ redundant) are given. It is thus better to first identify relationship between which two persons is exactly required to be found out in the question. And then proceed to track the relationship based on the descriptions connected to them. Again properly understanding the relationship between which two persons is exactly required to be found out in the question is important as the relationship between A and B would be different than between B and A. For example, if Ravi and Mala are brother and sister, Ravi is related to Mala as brother, whereas Mala is related to Ravi as sister.

Also remember that terms like 'only son' only means that the person do not have other son, but it does not mean that the person doesn't have daughter/s. However, when it is said a person does not have any brothers and sisters, it can be safely concluded that he is the only child of his father/ mother.

Quite often a candidate depending upon whether he is male or female presumes that a person whose sex is not explicitly referred to in the relationships is of the same sex as that of his/her. Such bias about the sex of the persons referred to the relationships should be avoided and the candidate should go strictly by the description given in the question.

Often the relationships are described in a round about way. Some examples of such descriptions and their actual/direct meaning is given below:

- Only son of my grand father - My Father
- Only son of my grandmother - My Father

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- c) Only daughter of my grandfather – My Mother
- d) Only daughter of my grandmother – My Mother
- e) Sister of my mother – My Aunt
- f) Son/Daughter of my husband – My son / daughter
- g) Son/Daughter of my wife – My son / daughter
- h) Only daughter of my grandfather's only son – My Sister
- i) Grandmother of my father's only son – My Grandmother
- j) Father of my daughter's father – My Father k) Father of my son's father – My Father
- l) My son's sister – My daughter
- m) Daughter-in-law of grandmother of my father's only son – My Mother
- n) A is the father of B but B is not the son of A – B is daughter of A

After the answer is found, it is good practice to quickly check back the answers with the relevant information given in the question.



Example:- Pinky, who is Victor's daughter, say to Lucy, "Your Mother Rosy is the younger sister of my Father, who is the third child of Joseph." How is Joseph related to Lucy?

- a) Father - In - Law
- b) Father
- c) Maternal Uncle
- d) Grand Father

Solution

(Option D)



Example. Mohan is the Son of Arun's Father's sister. Prakash is the son of Reva, who is the mother of Vikas

and Grandmother of Arun. Pranab is the father of Neela and the grandfather of Mohan. Reva is the wife of Pranab. How is the wife of Vikas related to the neela?

- a) Sister
- b) Sister - In - Law
- c) Niece
- d) None of The Above

Solution

(Option B)



Example: T, S and R are three brothers. T's son Q is married to K and they have one child Rahul blessed to them. M the son of S is married to H and this couple is blessed with a daughter Madhvi. R has a

daughter N who is married to P. This couple has one daughter Karuna born to them. How is Madhvi

related to S?

- a) Daughter
- b) Niece
- c) Grand Daughter
- d) None of The Above

Solution

Analytical Skills-I

(Option C)



Example:- Arti and Saurabh are the children of Mr and Mrs Shah. Ritu and Shakti are the children of Mr and

Mrs. Mehra. Saurabh and Ritu are married to each other and two daughter Mukti and Shruti are born to them. Shakti is married to Rina and two children Subhash and Reshma are born to them. How is Arti

related to Shruti?

- a) Mother
- b) Mother - in - Law
- c) Sister
- d) Aunt

Solution

(Option D)

Summary

The key concepts learned from this unit are: -

- We have learnt how find Family or Blood Relationship.
- We have learnt how find Relationships Involving the Term ' -in-law' General
- We have learnt how find Relationships Involving Father-in-law, Mother-in-law, Son-in-law and Daughter-in-law
- We have learnt how find Relationships Involving Brother-in-law and Sister-in-law
- We have learnt how find Relationships Half Sibling and Step Relations.

Keywords

- Blood Relationship
- Relationships
- Coding-Decoding

Self Assessment

1. Anil, introducing a girl in a party, said, she is the wife of the 12, grandson of my mother.
How is Anil related to the girl?
 - A. Father
 - B. Grandfather
 - C. Husband
 - D. Father-in-law
2. A man said to a woman, —Your mother's husband's sister is my aunt. How is the woman related to the man?
 - A. Granddaughter
 - B. Daughter
 - C. Sister
 - D. Aunt
3. Introducing Rajesh, Neha said, —His brother's father is the only son of my grandfather. How Neha is related to Rajesh?
 - A. Sister
 - B. Daughter
 - C. Mother

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D. Niece

4. Vinod is the brother of Bhaskar. Manohar is the sister of Vinod. Biswal is the brother of Preetam and Preetam is the daughter of Bhaskar. Who is the uncle of Biswal?

- A. Bhaskar
- B. Manohar
- C. Vinod
- D. Insufficient data

5. A man said to a woman, —Your brother's only sister is my mother. What is the relation of the woman with the maternal grandmother of that man?

- A. Mother
- B. Sister
- C. Niece
- D. Daughter

6. Pointing to a photograph, a man said, —I have no brother or sister but that man's father is my father's son. Whose photograph was it?

- A. His own
- B. His son's
- C. His father's
- D. His nephew's

7. Pointing to a photograph, a lady tells Pramod, —I am the only daughter of this lady and her son is your maternal uncle. How is the speaker related to Pramod's father?

- A. Sister-in-law
- B. Wife
- C. Neither (a) nor (b)
- D. Aunt

8. A is the brother of B. A is the brother of C. To find what is the relation between B and C. What minimum information from the following is necessary?

- (i) Gender of C (ii) Gender of B
- A. Only (i)
- B. Only (ii)
- C. Either (i) or (ii)
- D. both (i) and (ii)

9. Looking at a portrait of a man, Harsh said, "His mother is the wife of my father's son. Brothers and sisters I have none." At whose portrait was Harsh looking?

- A. His son
- B. His cousin
- C. His uncle
- D. His nephew

10. A, B, C, D, E, F and G are members of a family consisting of 4 adults and 3 children, two of whom, F and G are girls. A and D are brothers and A is a doctor. E is an engineer married to one of the brothers and has two children. B is married to D and G is their child. Who is C?

- A. G's brother
- B. F's father
- C. E's father
- D. A's son

11. In a family of 5, P is the father of R. S is Q's son. S has R as sister. Therefore, if U has P as brother, then the relationship between Q and U is as follows.

- A. Q is U's daughter
- B. U is Q's wife
- C. Q is the sister-in-law of U
- D. Q is U's brother-in-law

Analytical Skills-I

12. A, B and C are sisters. D is the brother of E and E is the daughter of B. How is A related to D?
 - A. Sister
 - B. Cousin
 - C. Niece
 - D. Aunt
13. F is the brother of A. C is the daughter of A. K is the sister of F. G is the brother of C. Who is the uncle of G?
 - A. A
 - B. C
 - C. F
 - D. K
14. P is the brother of Q and R. S is the R's mother. T is P's father. Which of the following statements cannot be definitely true?
 - A. T is Q's father
 - B. S is P's mother
 - C. T is S's husband
 - D. S is T's son
15. A party consisted of a man, his wife, his three sons and their wives and three children in each son's family. How many were there in the party?
 - A. 24
 - B. 22
 - C. 13
 - D. 17

Answers for Self Assessment

- | | | | | |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| 1. D | 2. C | 3. A | 4. C | 5. D |
| 6. B | 7. B | 8. D | 9. A | 10. D |
| 11. C | 12. D | 13. C | 14. D | 15. D |

Review Questions

1. Pointing to Ajay, Radha said, "His father is the only son of my grandfather". How is Radha Related to Ajay?
2. Lalita said to Tina, "You are the daughter-in-law of the grandmother of my father's only son."
3. Pointing to a photograph, Amar said, "I have no brother or sister but that man's father is my father's son." Whose photograph was it? How is Lalita related to Tina?
4. Looking at the portrait of a man, Ashok said, 'His mother is the wife of my father's son. Brothers and sisters I have none'. At whose portrait was Ashok looking?
5. Ahmad said to Saira, 'Your only brother's son is my wife's brother'. How is Saira related to the Ahmad's wife?
6. Pointing to a gentleman, Abdul said, "His only brother is the father of my daughter's father". How is the gentleman related to Abdul?"

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7. Pointing to a man in a photograph, Malati tells, "His brother's father is the only son of my grandfather." How is Malati related to the man in the photograph?
8. Pointing to Dharmendra, Hema said, "He is the son of my father's only son." How is Dharmendra's mother related to Hema?
9. Mr. 'Ashok' meets Mr. 'Babu'. 'Babu' is the father of a son 'Dharmendra' and a daughter 'Chandrika'. 'Shalini' is the mother of 'Ashok' 'Dharmendra' is married has one son. 'Shalini' is the daughter-in-law of 'Babu'. How is 'Ashok' related to 'Babu'.
10. Pointing to a photograph, a lady tells Bhushan, "I am the only daughter of this lady and her son is your maternal uncle." How is the speaker related to Bhushan's father?

**Further Readings**

1. Quantitative Aptitude For Competitive Examinations By Dr. R S Aggarwal, S Chand Publishing
2. A Modern Approach To Verbal & Non-Verbal Reasoning By Dr. R S Aggarwal, S Chand Publishing
3. Magical Book On Quicker Maths By M Tyra, Banking Service Chronicle
4. Analytical Reasoning By M.K. Pandey, Banking Service Chronicle